

Ang Li

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Education

New York University

Ph.D. in Computer Science

Advised by [Pavel Izmailov](#) and [Micah Goldblum](#)

2025 - Present

Columbia University

M.S. in Computer Science

Advised by [Micah Goldblum](#), [Tianyi Peng](#), and [Hongseok Namkoong](#)

2025

Columbia University

B.S. in Computer Science

Magna Cum Laude

2024

Experience

Modal Labs

Researcher

- Empirical science of scaling RL
- Automated post-training for enterprise agents

New York, NY

Feb 2026 - Present

New York University

Research Assistant

- Continual learning and long context
- Science of post-training

New York, NY

Aug 2025 - Present

Relace AI

Research Intern

- RL for SWE agents

San Francisco, CA

June 2025 - Aug 2025

Columbia Engineering, Electrical Engineering

Research Assistant, Advised by Micah Goldblum

- AI agent safety
- Visual chain of thought

New York, NY

Sep 2024 - July 2025

Columbia Business School, Decision, Risk, and Operations

Research Assistant, Advised by Tianyi Peng, Jing Dong, and Hongseok Namkoong

- Efficient RLHF
- Personalization
- LLM Based Simulation of Human

New York, NY

Jan 2023 - May 2025

Columbia's Center for Theoretical Neuroscience at Zuckerman Institute

Research assistant at Professor Larry Abbott's Lab

- Neural network interpretability
- Memory and Plasticity.

New York, NY

May 2022 - May 2023

Selected Publications

Understanding Reasoning from Pretraining to Post-Training

Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS 2026)

Jingyan Shen*, **Ang Li***, Salman Rahman, Yifan Sun, Micah Goldblum, Matus Telgarsky, and Pavel Izmailov

2026

End-to-End Context Compression at Scale

2026

ICML 2026 Workshop on Structured Probabilistic Inference & Generative Modeling

Ang Li*, Sean McLeish*, Haozhe Chen*, Nimit Kalra, Zaiqian Chen, Artem Gazizov, Venkata Anoop Suhas Kumar Morisetty, Bhavya Kailkhura, Harshitha Menon, Zhuang Liu, Brian R. Bartoldson, Tom Goldstein, Sanae Lotfi, Micah Goldblum, Pavel Izmailov

Teaching Pretrained Language Models to Think Deeper with Retrofitted Recurrence

2025

Conference on Language Modeling (COLM 2026)

Sean McLeish, **Ang Li**, John Kirchenbauer, Dayal Kalra, Brian R. Bartoldson, Bhavya Kailkhura, Avi Schwarzschild, Jonas Geiping, Tom Goldstein, Micah Goldblum

Zebra-CoT: A Dataset for Interleaved Vision Language Reasoning

2025

International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR 2026)

Ang Li*, Charles Wang*, Deqing Fu*, Kaiyu Yue*, Zikui Cai*, Wang Bill Zhu*, Ollie Liu*, Peng Guo*, Willie Neiswanger, Furong Huang, Tom Goldstein, Micah Goldblum

Twin-2K-500: A dataset for building digital twins of over 2,000 people based on their answers to over 500 questions

2025

Marketing Science

Olivier Toubia, George Z Gui, Tianyi Peng, Daniel J Merlau, **Ang Li**, Haozhe Chen

Commercial LLM Agents Are Already Vulnerable to Simple Yet Dangerous Attacks

2025

arXiv Preprint

Ang Li*, Yin Zhou*, Vethavikashini Chithrra Raghuram*, Tom Goldstein, Micah Goldblum

LLM Generated Persona is a Promise with a Catch

2025

Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS 2025)

Ang Li, Haozhe Chen, Hongseok Namkoong, Tianyi Peng

PersonalLLM: Tailoring LLMs to Individual Preferences

2025

International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR 2025)

Thomas Zollo*, Andrew Siah*, Naimeng Ye, **Ang Li**, Hongseok Namkoong

Talks & Service

AWS Responsible AI Group

Online

Invited talk

2025

AI Agent Safety

Columbia DRO Group

New York, NY

Invited talk

Reinforcement Learning for LLM Reasoning

NYU Center for Data Science

New York, NY

Teaching Assistant

Fall 2025 - Present

- CSCI-GA 3033-125 Special Topics: RL with Foundation Models

Columbia Computer Science Department

New York, NY

Teaching Assistant

Jan 2023 - Dec 2023

- COMS 4705 Natural Language Processing (Spring 2023, Fall 2023)

Reviewer: Nature (2025), NeurIPS (2025, 2026), ICLR (2026, 2027), COLM (2025), TMLR (2025)

Skills

ML Engineering PyTorch, FSDP, DeepSpeed, Megatron, TorchTitan, Miles, slime, verl